

USA: State and overseas territory flags

The date when each state joined the Union is shown below the state name.



WEST VIRGINIA

1863

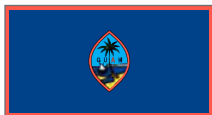
The coat of arms dates from 1863 when West Virginia seceded from Virginia. The current version of the flag was adopted in 1929 and has the arms within a wreath of rhododendron, the state flower.



WYOMING

1890

The flag emerged from a design competition and was adopted in 1917. The flag has been revised several times—at one time the buffalo containing the arms faced the fly. The colors recall the national flag.



GUAM

The flag was designed locally and adopted in 1917. In the center of the flag, in the US colors, is the seal of the territory, which depicts an idealized landscape. The flag can only be flown with the US flag.



PUERTO RICO

The resemblance of this flag to that of Cuba is no coincidence, since the two were designed at the same time, by the same activists. This version was adopted in 1952.



WISCONSIN

1848

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1848

The flag is derived from the militia colors of the Union in 1863. It depicts the state seal, supported by a miner and a sailor. The shield also recalls mining and sailing. The name and the date were added in 1980.



AMERICAN SAMOA

A self-governing US dependency, American Samoa's flag shows its links with the guardian state, in the colors and the American bald eagle. Here the eagle carries Samoan emblems.



**NORTHERN
MARIANA ISLANDS**

The original flag was adopted in 1972, but has undergone several modifications, including the addition of the flower-wreath. It also depicts a gray latte stone representing the islands' Chamorro culture.



**VIRGIN ISLANDS
(US)**

The flag dates from 1921 and uses part of the US seal, with the initials of the islands. The three arrows in one claw stand for the main islands; in the other claw is an olive branch.